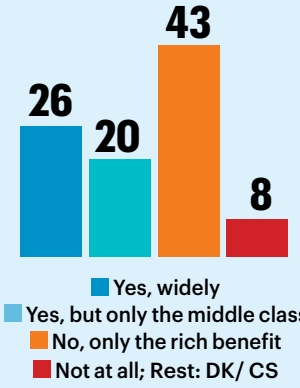
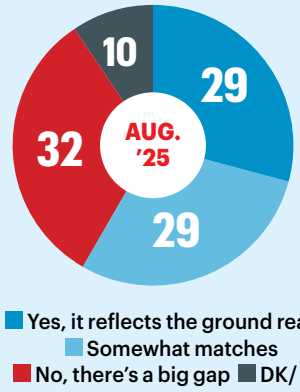
Q. Are the benefits of India's economic growth reaching the common people?



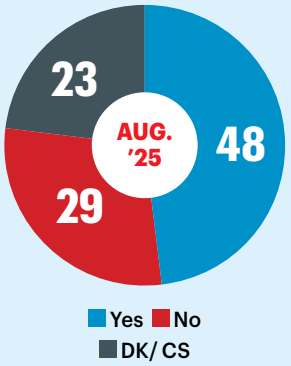
Nearly half feel the growth benefits only the rich; just a quarter believe gains are widely shared

Q. Does India's global economic image match the quality of infrastructure and public services in your area?



A third feel India's global economic image contrasts with weaker infrastructure and local public services

Q. Do you think the bureaucracy is a hindrance to India's economic development?

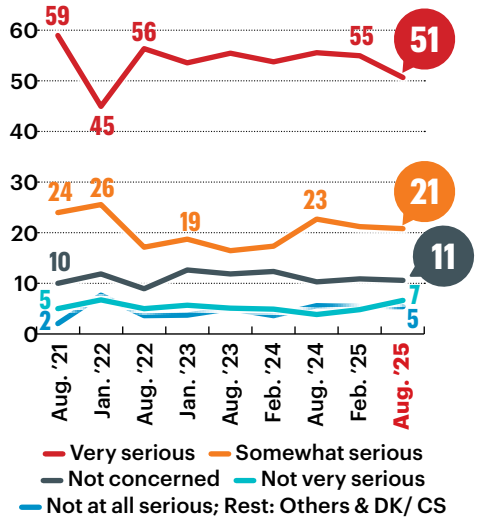


A majority see bureaucracy as a key hurdle to growth

2023. Yet amid the gloom, there is a sliver of reassurance: the proportion of those expecting conditions to stagnate or worsen has edged down to 55 per cent, from 56.9 per cent in February.

Modi's once-commanding lead over his predecessor in economic credibility appears to be narrowing. Asked who has managed the economy better—Narendra Modi or Manmohan Singh—just 44.6 per cent back Modi, down from 51.1 per cent in February and the lowest since August 2023. Support for Manmohan Singh, by contrast, has crept up to 43.1 per cent, from 39.9 per cent six months ago. Public sentiment on personal economic wellbeing tells a similar story: 33.7 per cent say their financial situation has worsened since Modi took office, up from 30.9 per cent in February. Only 33.1 per cent report an improvement, a slight decline from 34.9 per cent earlier this year.

Q. What is your opinion of the unemployment situation in the country?



More than 70 per cent respondents are concerned about unemployment

Rising Disparity

In May, NITI Aayog CEO B.V.R. Subrahmanyam declared that India had overtaken Japan to become the world's fourth-largest economy, citing data from the International Monetary Fund (IMF). Some analysts quibbled over the timing, saying India still had some months to go before it could officially lay claim to that distinction. Yet such objections are largely pedantic. With developed countries like Japan growing at a rate much more tepid than India, overtaking Germany to claim third place appears a question of when, not if. But what does this mean for the ordinary citizen? Very little, going by the MOTN poll. Asked